Lab: Adding Dashboard Extensions in Tableau

Estimated time needed: **15** minutes.

In this lab, you will learn how to add dashboard extensions to Tableau.

Required Software

You can complete this lab using the free, downloadable **Tableau Desktop (Public Edition)** desktop software. You may also use the free **Tableau Public online platform**, but some tasks may not work in exactly the same way or may not be supported in that version.

Prerequisites

You need a free Tableau Public account for this lab. If you haven't already done so, you can sign up for an account using the steps here.

Data Set

This lab uses a sample data set called **World Indicators Data.xxx** to showcase the Tableau features used in these lab exercises.

Hold the CTRL key while you click to download the following file:

World Indicators Data.xxx

Objectives

The exercises in this lab teach you how to add dashboard extensions to a Tableau workbook. This feature can help make your dashboards more interactive.

In this hands-on lab, you will:

1. Add dashboard extensions

Exercise: Add dashboard extensions

In this exercise, you will add a dashboard extension to your **Interactive Dashboard** workbook.

For this exercise, you need to download the **showmemore.trex** file. To do so, you need to create a free trial account on the **Infotopics** portal (an extension to use .trex file in Tableau) using the following link: https://exportfromtableau.infotopics.com/, which is valid for only 14 days. You can follow the steps below to create an account and download the .trex file.

It is recommended to complete this lab before your free trial expires.

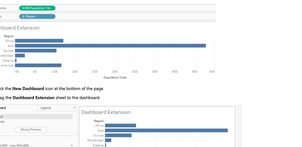
Step 1: Go to https://exportfromtableau.infotopics.com/.

Step 2: Click the **Try Now** option on the top right corner of the page. Under **Extensions**, click **Request Free Trial** button to create a free account.

Step 3: Add all the required details to request for a free trial.

If you are a student, you can use the default company name and role.

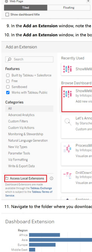
Step 4: Once your account is successfully created, you will receive a confirmation email at your registered email address with the trial expiry date. Then, you can access the products as shown below.



Step 5: Under **Products**, scroll down and go to the **ShowMeMore extension** and click **Download TREX** option to get the .trex file to your local machine.

Now that you have successfully downloaded the .trex file, you are now ready to begin with the next tasks:

1. Switch back to Tableau Desktop (Public Edition).
2. If you have closed the **Interactive Dashboard** workbook, then click **File** and select the workbook from the recently used file list in the menu.

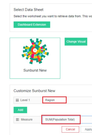


3. At the bottom of the page, click the **New Worksheet** icon.
4. Drag **Region** to **Rows** and **Population Total** to **Columns** to create a bar chart.
5. Double click the **Sheet 4** worksheet tab, type **Dashboard Extension** and press Enter.

6. Click the **New Dashboard** icon at the bottom of the page.
7. Drag the **Dashboard Extension** sheet to the dashboard.

8. Under **Objects** in the left pane, drag the **Extension** object to the lower part of the dashboard area.

9. In the **Add an Extension** window, note the **ShowMeMore 2.0** extension, but do not select it. (If you do, just click the left arrow in the top left corner of the dialog box to go back)
10. In the **Add an Extension** window, in the bottom left corner, click **Access Local Extensions**.



11. Navigate to the folder where you downloaded the **showmemore.trex** file to, and click **Open**.

12. Click **Configuration** from the **ShowMeMore** work area.
13. Select the **Dashboard Extension** data sheet.

14. From the list of suggested visualizations, select **Sunburst New**. This visualization uses one dimension and one measure.

15. Under **Customize Sunburst New**, in the **Level 1** drop down list, select **Region**.
16. In the **Measure* drop down list**, select **SUM(Population Total)*** and click **OK**.

17. This will display a new custom visualization comparing the population for each region.

Congratulations! You have completed this lab and are ready for the next topic.

Author(s)

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